

PRDs (Product Requirements Documents)

This article describes the full lifecycle of a Product Requirements Document (PRD).

Creating a PRD is the *required* first step for any feature development or, more broadly, whenever work *isn't* considered either Operational or Keep the Lights On (KTLO).

WHAT IS A PRD?

A **Product Requirements Document (PRD)** is a structured document whose completion and inclusion is a required step in the TEA Software Development process. Its purpose is to capture an explanation for **what you're building, why you're building it, and how success will be measured**.

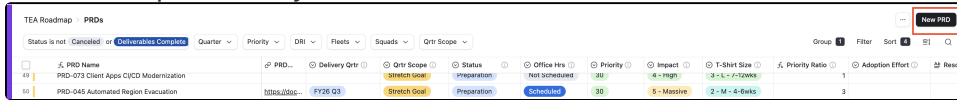
 All feature development work must begin with a PRD unless total estimated work will take <1 sprint to complete.

HOW A PRD HELPS	WHAT A PRD INCLUDES
• Define the problem - What user or business need are we solving • Clarify the solution - What features or functionality will address that problem • Align teams - Ensures everyone is working toward the same goal • Guide development - Acts as a reference throughout the build process • Measure success- Establishes clear criteria for whether the product/feature worked	• Overview / Summary - High-level description of the feature or product and why it matters • Problem Statement - The specific business problem with supporting context or data • Goals & Success Metrics - What success looks like (e.g., measurable KPIs) • Scope - What's included and excluded • Requirements - What the system must do and expectations (performance, reliability, security, etc.) • Dependencies & Risks - External systems, teams, constraints, or potential blockers • Timeline / Milestones - Key dates or phases

HOW TO CREATE A PRD

NEW PRD

1. A PRD **must** be initiated by creating a [New PRD](#) entry in Airtable. This is where you'll enter basic information about your project/task after which the system will create a unique ID# for your PRD.

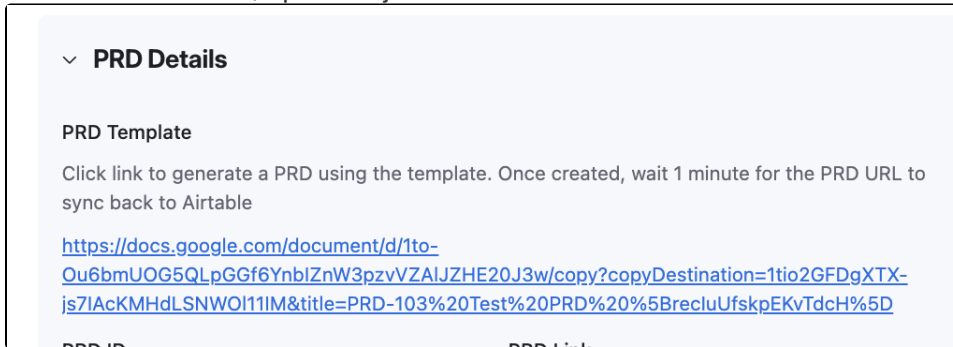


TEA Roadmap - PRDs									
Status	PRD Name	PRD ID	Delivery Qtr	Qtr Scope	Status	Office Hrs	Priority	Impact	1-3rd Size
Not Started	PRD-073 Client Apps C/CD Modernization				Preparation		High	High	3 - 5 - 7-10Wks
Not Started	PRD-045 Automated Region Evaluation	https://doc-	FY26 Q3	Stretch Goal	Preparation		Scheduled	30	5 - Massive

❗ Do not directly create a Google Doc in the PRDs Google Drive (covered in more detail below).

i Upon submission, a blank **PRD Template** will be automatically generated and attached to the PRD record just created in Airtable.

2. While still in Airtable, open the just-created PRD record and click the "PRD Template" URL.



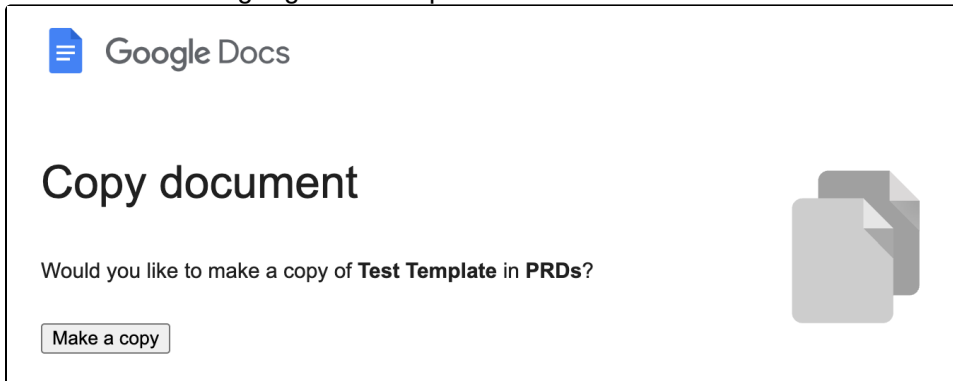
▼ **PRD Details**

PRD Template

Click link to generate a PRD using the template. Once created, wait 1 minute for the PRD URL to sync back to Airtable

<https://docs.google.com/document/d/1to-Ou6bmUOG5QLpGGf6YnblZnW3pzvVZAIJZHE20J3w/copy?copyDestination=1tio2GFDgXTX-Is7IAcKMHdLSNW0l1IM&title=PRD-103%20Test%20PRD%20%5BrecluUfskpEKvTdcH%5D>

You are taken to a screen where you can direct the system to create your own PRD document based on the PRD google doc template.



 **Google Docs**

Copy document

Would you like to make a copy of **Test Template** in **PRDs**?

[Make a copy](#)

3. Click the *Make a copy* button. The system will automatically pre-populate a new Google document with the details established in step #1 above and save it to the [PRD Google Drive](#).

i An automation runs once-a-minute to ensure that the Google Doc URL in the PRD record in Airtable is always up-to-date.

4. Fill out the PRD Google Doc as directed.

✓ This Google Doc should continue to be worked on until all sections are completed and it's ready for review and approval by leadership.

5. Once your PRD Google Doc is ready for review by leadership, return to the [PRD section of TEA Central in Airtable](#), find the record corresponding to your PRD, and enter the following details:
- Mark the Status Ready for Review. This will add your PRD to the review queue.
 - In the "Reviews" section, add anyone whom you'd explicitly like to be added as a reviewer
 - Add in the Score after running the rubric script in the template
6. If you have dependencies on other PRDs link them in the Dependencies section

The screenshot shows a form titled "Standard Metrics by Service Type" with tabs for "PRD Details", "Dependencies", "Deliverables", "Reviews", and "Temp Values". The "Dependencies" tab is active. It contains a section "Dependencies" with the instruction "Link related PRDs if relevant". Below this are two input fields: "Depends On" (PRD(s) this item depends on) and "Dependency For" (PRD(s) this item is a dependency for). The "Depends On" field has a plus sign icon. The "Dependency For" field has a dropdown menu showing "PRD-041 Canary Metric Standards" with a close button (X) and a plus sign icon below it.

UPDATING A PRD

NEW PRD

- When ready for review, update the Airtable record and fill out all details.
 - Mark the Status **Ready for Review** to add it to the review queue
 - Add in the Score after running the rubric script in the template
- Add anyone whom you'd like to explicitly review in the Review table

DEPENDENCIES

- If you have dependencies on other PRDs link them in the Dependencies section

This screenshot is identical to the one above, showing the "Dependencies" tab of the "Standard Metrics by Service Type" form. It highlights the "Depends On" and "Dependency For" input fields, which are used to link related PRDs.

a.

UNDERSTANDING DRI & TPM RESPONSIBILITIES w.r.t the PRD PROCESS

The Directly Responsible Individual (DRI) and Technical Program Manager (TPM) each have distinct responsibilities throughout the PRD and project lifecycle.

PRD Ownership

The Directly Responsible Individual (DRI) is the owner of the PRD and is ultimately accountable for completing the PRD and meeting the success criteria.

DRI RESPONSIBILITIES

- Intake approval
- Creation of PRD
- Breaking down tasks in Jira
- Delegation of work to individual contributors
- Completion and success of work

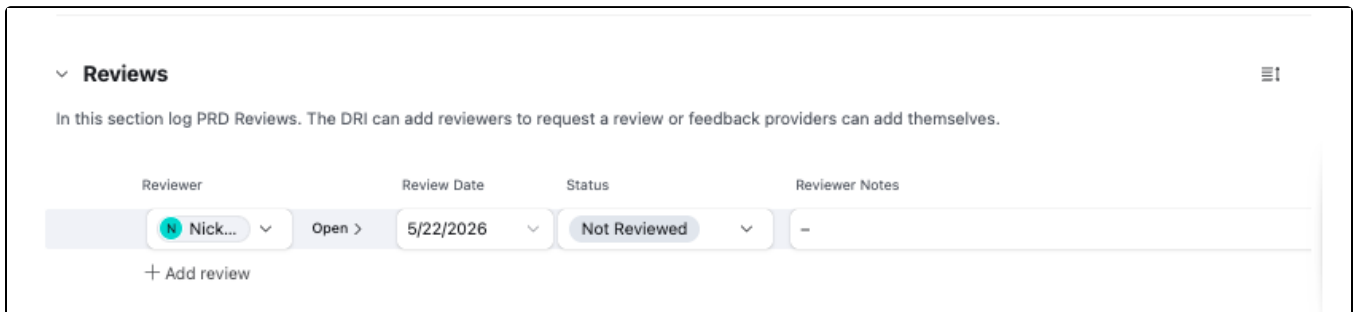
TPM RESPONSIBILITIES

- Mapping of work in TEA Central and Jira
- Ensuring all necessary fields are filled in TEA Central
- Regular progress reporting
- Initiative squad allocation in Downtown Disney (DTD)

REVIEW PROCESS

The [Airtable](#) record for your PRD includes a section where requests for- and logs of- PRD reviews are tracked. This table is meant to log the completion of a review and capture the overall review status.

- The DRI can add rows for each reviewer that they are requesting feedback from.
- Reviewers can go in and add themselves.
- Comments can be added directly in the PRD Google Doc by the Reviewer.



The screenshot shows the 'Reviews' section of an Airtable record. It includes a header 'Reviews' with a dropdown arrow and a menu icon. Below the header is a descriptive text: 'In this section log PRD Reviews. The DRI can add reviewers to request a review or feedback providers can add themselves.' A table with four columns is visible: 'Reviewer', 'Review Date', 'Status', and 'Reviewer Notes'. The first row shows a reviewer 'Nick...', a review date of '5/22/2026', a status of 'Not Reviewed', and an empty notes field. Below the table is a '+ Add review' button.

REVIEW NOTIFICATIONS

PRD Ready for Review Notifications

- A notification will be sent to the Teams Channel PRDs when a PRD is marked Status: Ready for Review
- *It is recommended to add this to your channels list if you are responsible for reviewing PRDs*

Individual Reviewer Notifications

- A notification will be sent via email from Airtable when a user is added as a Reviewer on the PRD record in Airtable

SUPPORTING INFRASTRUCTURE

AIRTABLE

PRDs are created and registered through the [TEA Central PRDs Airtable interface](#). The Airtable is used to drive the workflow and capture structured data that will allow leadership to make prioritization decisions. It also allows for linking to Deliverables or Initiatives and rolling up work. The narrative for the PRD (what it is, success criteria, definition of done, etc.) lives in the Google Doc created after PRD registration in Airtable. Reviews will read the Google Doc and add comments. Airtable will be the source of truth for status.

Prioritization

PRDs will be prioritized into buckets of Priority (1, 10, 20, etc.) by Leadership. The highest priority PRDs should be focused on.

Fleet leaders will continue to stack rank (1-N) Deliverables in the Roadmap. Deliverables that are aligned with PRDs should be ranked the highest (or include justification for their relative ranking).

Squads may choose to stack within their teams if they feel it will help manage their workstream.

CEREMONY SERIES

To facilitate the PRD process and reviews, a series of ceremonies are being created.

For more details, please refer to [Ceremonies](#) for a complete list of ceremonies, including: purpose, audience, cadence, inputs/outputs, and other information.

HOOPS

Some PRDs will lead to the creation of a [HOOP](#). A HOOP is a formal change request that details the technical specifics of the implementation. The PRD outlines the idea, business value, and outcome, while the HOOP outlines how it will be built and technical tradeoffs.

** A more formal process will be documented in the future for how this will be integrated into TEA's roadmap process and TEA Central.*

INTAKE CRITERIA

PRD DECISION CRITERIA

NEW INTAKE REQUEST

When a new request comes in or managers consider taking on a project, they should evaluate it before accepting and prioritizing. The following questions are to help with this analysis and determination:

1. **Does this tie to an OKR?**
2. **Which thematic work bucket does this align with?**
 - a. Big Rocks (Super Bowl, World Cup, Delta/Gemini, etc)
 - b. Reliability (Prevent, Detect, Mitigate, Learn, Engage, Resolve)
 - c. KTLO
 - d. Deprecations
 - e. Features/Enhancements
 - f. Support/Consulting
3. **Does this work align with a TEA PRD, product or scope and responsibilities?**
 - a. Which current strategic priority or initiative does this request map to?
4. **How does this request enable a high-quality experience for our consumers?**
 - a. Which consumer-facing product does this request support?
5. **What problem does this solve, and what happens if we do not do it?**
 - a. Is this urgent, high-impact, risk-reducing, or nice-to-have?
6. **Does this improve operational health or reliability?**
 - a. Includes KTLO, maintenance, scalability, tech debt, compliance, and stability work.
7. **What is the level of effort?**
 - a. Is it less than 2 weeks of effort?
 - b. Estimated T-shirt size
 - c. Known Dependencies?
8. **What is the firm in-market date? Is there a contractual obligation for this?**
9. **Should this work be approved, deferred, redirected, or declined?**
 - a. If deferred:
 - i. Why?
 - ii. Until when?
 - iii. What priority took precedence?

WORK CATEGORIES

In addition to determining whether to take on the work, the list below can be used as a guideline to identify when a PRD may be needed.

Thematic Work Bucket	Example	Is a PRD Required	
OKR (XAlliance, Alliance, Fleet, Squad level)	Velocity - Critical User Journey Automation		
Big Rocks	Super Bowl, World Cup, Delta/Gemini		
Reliability (Prevent, Detect, Mitigate, Learn, Engage, Resolve)	Ops Dashboard enhancements		
Other Features /Enhancements	Service Guard Enhancements		
Maintenance	3rd-party software version upgrade		
Tech Debt	Code refactoring		
Compliance	Key Rotation		
Deprecations	Hulu GitHub repos		
Support /Consulting	Datadog users support request		

POSSIBLE OUTCOMES

The team can then decide how to move forward with any of these options:

- **Approve** aligns to priorities and available capacity
- **Defer** valuable, but not the right timing or priority
- **Redirect** better owned by another team or process
- **Decline** insufficient impact, urgency, or strategic alignment

SCORING

Once a PRD has been completed, in addition to manually reviewing the document, the DRI should run an automated script (*script instructions pending*) that evaluates it against the rubric below and provides a score and feedback for each category. **A score of at least 30 is considered "passing"**. Special attention should be paid to the "Success Metric" section, as it's critical to define how we determine whether an initiative has achieved its goals. This is an example of a PRD that received a maximum score of 34.5: [PRD-031 - Holonet \(Topology\)](#)

Section	1 (Needs Work)	2 (Acceptable)	3 (Strong)	Weight
Problem Statement	Missing, vague, or no end user identified	Present but generic; user implied, not explicit	Concrete pain, quantified if possible, clear end user	1.5x
Proposed Solution	Solution language without outcome; unclear capability	Describes capability but internal-focused	Clear outcome for consuming teams	1x
Q3 Scope	Missing items or vague deliverables	Deliverables listed but could be more specific	Specific, verifiable deliverables; clear out-of-scope	1.5x
Definition of Done	Missing or subjective ("feature is built")	Present but not fully verifiable	Verifiable, adoption-focused ("X teams using it")	2x
Success Metric	Missing metric, baseline, or target	Metric present, but baseline/target vague or TBD	Concrete metric, baseline, target, measurement method	2x
Dependencies	Missing or incomplete table	Dependencies listed but missing owner /status/date	Complete table with owners, status, and dates	1x
Adoption Path	Missing or "TBD"	Generic description	Clear onboarding mechanism, incentive, or enforcement explained	1x

Q3 Milestones	Missing or placeholder text	Milestones present but vague deliverables	Specific, progressive deliverables per checkpoint	1.5x
Max Total Score (all 3s): 34.5				

PRD AIRTABLE FIELDS

*Additional fields to be added and removed as needed

Column Name	Description	Required / Optional / Auto-filled
PRD ID	Auto-generated identifier in the format PRD-####. Contact TEA Central Support if adjustments are needed.	Auto-filled
PRD Name	Auto-generated display name combining the PRD ID and Name fields.	Auto-filled
Name	The short title/name of the PRD.	Required
Status	Lifecycle stage of the PRD. Options: Preparation, Ready for Review, PRD Approved, Deliverables in Progress, Deliverable Complete, Canceled, Deferred. <i>Do not set to "Ready for Review" until the PRD passes the rubric.</i>	Required
Leadership Approved	Checkbox to be filled by Leadership	Filled by Leadership
PRD Link	URL to the actual PRD document (e.g., Google Doc).	Filled in by Automation
DRI	Directly Responsible Individual — the person accountable for delivering this PRD.	Required
Impact	The impact on customers/platform if this work is delivered. Scale: 1 (Minimal) to 5 (Massive).	Required
T-Shirt Size	Effort estimate in person-weeks. Options: XS (1 wk), S (1–3 wks), M (4–6 wks), L (7–12 wks), XL (13–24 wks), XXL (24+ wks).	Required
Delivery Quarter	Projected fiscal quarter the PRD will be complete (e.g., FY26 Q4, FY27 Q1). Can be set to TBD.	Required
Quarter Scope	Whether this PRD is In Scope, a Stretch Goal, or Backlog for its target delivery quarter.	Required
Rubric Score	Numeric score from the PRD rubric. Must be 30 before moving to "Ready for Review."	Filled in later
Fleets	Fleets that will have Deliverables linked to this PRD.	Required

Squads	Squads that will have Deliverables linked to this PRD.	Required
Priority	Priority ranking set by TEA Leadership (Brandon / CV). Lower number = higher priority.	Provided by Leadership
Priority Ratio	Auto-calculated as Impact ÷ Effort. Higher score = high impact with less effort.	Auto-filled
Office Hours	Status of office hours scheduling for PRD review. Options: Not Scheduled, Scheduled, Completed, Follow-Up.	Filled in later
L4 Deliverables	Links to one or more L4 Deliverable records used to track execution of this PRD.	Filled in later
TPM	TPM responsible for planning and execution.	Required
PRD Reviews	Linked review records associated with this PRD.	Filled in later
Status Update	Running log of material changes (priority, scope, delivery quarter, etc.) with dates.	Filled in later
Prioritization Justification	Explanation of why this PRD is prioritized or deprioritized.	Optional
Resource Requests	Description of any additional resources or special skillsets needed to complete the work.	Optional
Depends On	Other PRDs that this PRD depends on before it can be completed.	Optional
Dependency For	Other PRDs that are blocked by this one.	Optional
Notes / Dependencies	Callouts such as dependencies on non-TEA teams or vendors.	Optional
Reliability Theme	Categorizes the PRD under a reliability theme: Prevent, Detect, Mitigate, Learn, Engage, Resolve, or Diagnose.	Optional
Stakeholders	Additional stakeholders involved beyond the DRI.	Optional

FAQ

- Can a deliverable (L4) have more than 1 PRD?
 - No, a deliverable should map to a single PRD
- Can a PRD be used for more than 1 deliverable (L4)?
 - Yes, the same PRD can be used for multiple deliverables if the scope is large enough.
- Can a PRD be linked to an initiative (L3)?
 - Yes, PRDs can be linked to either an Initiative (L3) or Deliverable (L4).